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FOOD WASTE DISPOSER

Abstract

Embodiments of the present disclosure relate to a food waste disposer, and more specifically, to a food waste disposer which prevents the formation of a blind spot where food accumulates through the shape of a chamber in which food and microorganisms are accommodated, and improves the efficiency of food decomposition and processing by effectively stirring the food and microorganisms using blades and stirring rods.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED PATENT APPLICATION

[0001] The present application claims priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119 (a) to Korean patent application number 10-2024-0029493 filed on Feb. 29, 2024, in the Korean Intellectual Property Office, the entire disclosure of which is incorporated by reference herein.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

1. Field

[0002] Embodiments of the present disclosure relate to a food waste disposer, and more specifically, to a food waste disposer which prevents formation of a blind spot where food accumulates through the shape of a chamber in which food and microorganisms are accommodated, and improves the efficiency of food decomposition and processing by effectively stirring the food and microorganisms using blades and stirring rods.

2. Description of the Related Art

[0003] In general, a certain amount of food waste is discharged daily from each household, restaurant, or the like, and such food waste is either used as livestock feed as it is or disposed of after filtering out the mixed moisture through a simple strainer. This method of processing food waste increases the amount of waste, and if the waste is not disposed of frequently, it produces a foul odor and pollutes the surrounding air.

[0004] Recently, efforts to reduce food waste in households and restaurants have been actively promoted, but controlling the gradually increasing amount of waste involves various difficulties, and when it is landfilled, not only is the landfill space limited, but also environmental damage caused by the foul odor and leachate has become extremely serious.

[0005] Therefore, a volume-rate waste disposal system has recently been implemented, and it has been regulated that food waste disposers which may induce fermentation or drying of food must be installed in newly constructed group cafeterias or apartment complexes, and each household is also increasingly adopting domestic food waste disposers to reduce food waste.

[0006] Food waste with a high moisture content is prone to rotting if left as is, and it emits a foul odor, damaging the surrounding sanitary environment, and many companies have attempted to develop technologies to deal with this, and have released food waste disposer products using various technologies, such as a hot air circulation drying method, a hot air circulation drying method with added stirring function, a hot air circulation drying method with added stirring and grinding function, a decomposing method using a stirring function and microorganisms, and a refrigerated storage method, etc., for processing food waste in households and restaurants.

[0007] Among these, a conventional food waste disposer with a general stirring and grinding function includes a processing part in which introduced food waste is processed, and the processing part is provided with a blade that grinds and stirs the food waste.

[0008] However, the conventional food waste disposer has a problem in that the blade rotates to stir while moving the food waste to one side, causing a phenomenon of food waste crowding within the processing part, and as a result, the stirring efficiency of the food waste is reduced, and it becomes difficult to discharge the processed food waste.

[0009] Further, the conventional food waste disposer has a problem in that, due to the viscosity of the food waste, overall stirring does not occur inside the chamber of the processing part, causing the food waste to stuck to the inner surface or corners, which makes it difficult to discharge the food waste, and only the food waste at the location where the blade is provided is ground and

stirred, making it difficult to grind and stir stuck food or food accommodated at a location far from the location of the blade.

[0010] In addition, the conventional food waste disposer has a problem in that, since the amount of food waste accommodated inside the processing part is visually checked by a user or an operator when introducing food, even if food is introduced with an input amount exceeding the predetermined capacity, it is difficult to visually identify, and as a result, the stirring and processing efficiency of the food waste disposer decreases, and frequent malfunctions occur to the food waste disposer.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0011] The present disclosure has been devised to solve the problems described above, and more specifically, to provide a food waste disposer which prevents formation of a blind spot where food accumulates through the shape of a chamber in which food and microorganisms are accommodated, improves the efficiency of food decomposition and processing by effectively stirring the food and microorganisms using blades and stirring rods, and prevents food from being excessively introduced into the chamber and reducing the decomposition efficiency by providing a distance sensor.

[0012] A food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure is a food waste disposer for stirring food and microorganisms to process the food to be decomposed, including: a processing part provided with a chamber formed so that a predetermined accommodation space is formed to accommodate food and microorganisms inside and a lower part has a semi-cylindrical shape, a rotating shaft which is rotationally driven inside the chamber, and a stirring rod having one end which is vertically connected to an outer circumferential surface of the rotating shaft and is driven together with the rotating shaft to stir the food and microorganisms accommodated in the chamber; an input part formed on an upper part of the processing part and provided so that the food and microorganisms are introduced from outside into the chamber, in which an input port is formed so that a predetermined area is open; a driving part configured to provide power so that the rotating shaft and the stirring rod are rotationally driven; and a discharge part provided to discharge the food decomposed through the processing part to the outside.

[0013] More specifically, the chamber may further include a chamfered part configured to form a sloped surface of a predetermined angle on at least one edge.

[0014] More specifically, the rotating shaft may be disposed in a direction perpendicular to a direction in which the food and microorganisms are introduced into the chamber, and have both ends coupled and fixed to center parts of side surfaces of the chamber.

[0015] More specifically, the stirring rod may be rotationally driven while moving along a longitudinal direction of the rotating shaft on the outer circumferential surface of the rotating shaft.

[0016] More specifically, the rotating shaft may be provided with a screw thread on the outer circumferential surface to form a movement path of the stirring rod.

[0017] More specifically, a plurality of the stirring rods may be provided so that each stirring rod is movable in a form of gathering toward a center in the longitudinal direction of the rotating shaft or scattering toward both ends of the rotating shaft.

[0018] More specifically, the rotating shaft may further include a plurality of slots formed to be recessed or penetrate to a predetermined depth from the outer circumferential surface toward a center and spaced apart from each other by a predetermined distance in the longitudinal direction of the rotating shaft, and the stirring rod may be provided to be detachably attached to the slot, allowing an installation location to be changed according to a formation location of the slot.

[0019] More specifically, the processing part may include a first blade which is coupled to another end of the stirring rod being perpendicular to a longitudinal direction of the stirring rod to form a predetermined contact area to contact the food and microorganisms.

[0020] More specifically, the first blade may be disposed at a predetermined angle tilted from the rotating shaft to form an oblique line.

[0021] More specifically, the first blade may further include a first brush formed to be detachably attached to one end part of the first blade, on which areas recessed from an outer side toward a center to a predetermined depth are repeatedly formed while being spaced apart from each other by a predetermined distance.

[0022] More specifically, the processing part may include a second blade which is coupled to a side surface of the stirring rod being parallel to a longitudinal direction of the stirring rod to form a predetermined contact area to contact the food and microorganisms.

[0023] More specifically, the second blade may be disposed so that a width direction is perpendicular to the longitudinal direction of the rotating shaft.

[0024] More specifically, the second blade may further include a second brush formed to be detachably attached to one side end part of the second blade, on which areas recessed from an outer side toward a center to a predetermined depth are repeatedly formed while being spaced apart from each other by a predetermined distance.

[0025] More specifically, the processing part may include a third blade having a plate shape and provided with a bending part of a predetermined angle, and formed by being coupled to the stirring rod so that both surfaces contact a side surface of the stirring rod based on the bending part to form a predetermined contact area to contact the food and microorganisms.

[0026] More specifically, a plurality of the third blades may be provided and disposed to be spaced apart from each other by a predetermined distance in a longitudinal direction of the stirring rod.

[0027] More specifically, the input part may include an input cover provided to open and close the input port, and a cover packing formed by being attached to a lower edge of the input cover and provided to seal the chamber when the input port is closed.

[0028] More specifically, the cover packing may include at least one protrusion formed to protrude in a vertical direction from one surface toward the outside at a predetermined height and formed along a longitudinal direction of the cover packing.

[0029] More specifically, the input part may include a distance sensor mounted in a vertical direction on a lower surface of the input cover and provided to detect a height of the food and microorganisms accommodated inside the chamber when the input port is closed.

[0030] More specifically, the distance sensor may be configured to generate a warning notification when the detected height of the food and microorganisms exceeds a preset reference range.

[0031] More specifically, the discharge part may include a discharge port provided on one side of the processing part and formed so that a predetermined area is open, and a discharge cover provided to open and close the discharge port.

[0032] More specifically, the discharge part may further include a mesh box formed by being coupled to both sides of the discharge port so as to cover the discharge port while forming a predetermined hollow area near the discharge port and provided to be movable up and down based on the discharge port.

[0033] More specifically, the discharge cover may be formed so that an upper end is fixedly coupled to an upper part of the discharge port and a lower part is rotatable in an outward direction from the discharge port based on the upper end, and may be provided in a mesh form in which a plurality of holes are formed.

[0034] More specifically, the food waste disposer may include a status display part provided to output various information, including information about an operation status of the food waste disposer, information about the food and microorganisms accommodated inside the chamber, and information about a progress status of food processing, in visual and auditory forms.

[0035] A food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure includes a chamber formed so that the lower part has a semi-cylindrical shape, allowing food and microorganisms inside to gather toward the center while being stirred by stirring rods and blades, thereby preventing the formation of an area in the lower side part where food and microorganisms are not stirred and accumulate, thereby preventing a decrease in the efficiency of decomposition

and processing of food

[0036] In particular, a food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure includes a chamfered part forming an inclined surface at a predetermined angle at the edge of the chamber, thereby preventing the formation of a blind spot or dead zone in which food and microorganisms are not stirred because they do not come into contact with the stirring rod or blade, thereby further improving the efficiency of decomposition and processing of the food waste disposer, and by forming the length of the stirring rod near the chamfered part short, the driving resistance occurring in the stirring rod may be minimized, thereby providing an effect of preventing damage to the food waste disposer.

[0037] Further, a food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure includes first and second brushes that are formed to be detachably attached to the first and second blades, so that the shape of the blades may be changed when using depending on the type or characteristics of the food to be processed, and food may be prevented from becoming entangled or lumped, so that the stirring of food and microorganisms may be facilitated, thereby providing an effect of improving the speed of food processing.

[0038] In addition, the food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure includes a protrusion formed along the longitudinal direction of the cover packing, so that when the input cover is closed to close the input port, it adheres more strongly to the inner side surface or peripheral part of the input port, thereby preventing dust generated inside the chamber from leaking out through the input port, thereby providing an effect of further improving the sealing capacity of the space inside the chamber.

[0039] In addition, the food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure includes a distance sensor that detects the height of food and microorganisms accommodated inside the chamber and generates a warning notification when the height exceeds a reference range, thereby preventing excessive food from being introduced into the chamber and reducing the efficiency of decomposition and processing of the food, and the process of a user directly opening the input cover and visually checking the input amount when using the food waste disposer is unnecessary, thereby providing an effect of increasing user convenience.

[0040] In addition, a food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure includes a mesh box that forms a hollow area near the discharge port and is movable up and down based on the discharge port, thereby ensuring a safe distance for the user or operator from the discharge port, thereby providing an effect of preventing an accident from occurring in advance due to the user's or operator's hand being caught inside the discharge port while the food waste disposer is in operation.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0041] FIG. 1 is a perspective view illustrating a food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0042] FIG. 2 is a plan view illustrating a state in which an input part of a food waste disposer is separated according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0043] FIG. 3 is a front view and a perspective view illustrating a processing part and a driving part of a food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0044] FIG. 4 is a plan view illustrating a processing part of a food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0045] FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating a detailed configuration of a processing part of a food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0046] FIG. 6 is a diagram illustrating a detailed configuration of a processing part of a food waste

disposer according to another additional embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0047] FIG. 7 is a diagram illustrating a first blade and a second blade according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0048] FIG. 8 is a diagram illustrating a detailed configuration of a processing part of a food waste disposer according to another embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0049] FIG. 9 is a diagram illustrating a detailed configuration of an input part of a food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0050] FIG. 10 is a cross-sectional view illustrating a cover packing of a food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0051] FIG. 11 is a front view illustrating a discharge part of a food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0052] FIG. 12 is a perspective view illustrating a discharge part of a food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0053] FIG. 13 is a diagram illustrating a sequence for opening a discharge part of a food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0054] FIG. 14 is a perspective view illustrating a discharge part of a food waste disposer according to another embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0055] FIG. 15 is a side view illustrating a closed state and an open state of a discharge cover of a discharge part of a food waste disposer according to another embodiment of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0056] The following detailed description of the present disclosure refers to the accompanying drawings, which illustrate specific embodiments in which the present disclosure may be practiced. These embodiments are described in sufficient detail to enable those skilled in the art to practice the present disclosure. It should be understood that the various embodiments of the present disclosure, while different from one another, are not necessarily mutually exclusive. For example, the specific shapes, structures, and characteristics described herein may be implemented in other embodiments without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure with respect to an embodiment.

[0057] In addition, it should be understood that the location or arrangement of individual components within each disclosed embodiment may be changed without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure. Accordingly, the following detailed description is not intended to be limited, and the scope of the present disclosure is defined only by the appended claims, along with the full range of equivalents to which such claims are entitled, if appropriately described. Like reference numerals in the drawings designate the same or similar functions throughout the several aspects.

[0058] Hereinafter, in order to enable those skilled in the art to easily practice the present disclosure, preferred embodiments of the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings.

[0059] First, a food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure will be described with reference to FIGS. 1 to 3.

[0060] FIG. 1 is a perspective view illustrating a food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, FIG. 2 is a plan view illustrating a state in which an input part of a food waste disposer is separated according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, and FIG. 3 is a front view and a perspective view illustrating a processing part and a driving part of a food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0061] The food waste disposer of the present disclosure corresponds to a mechanism and device for stirring food and microorganisms to decompose food.

[0062] As illustrated in FIG. 1, a food waste disposer **1000** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure includes a processing part **100**, an input part **200**, a driving part **300**, a discharge part **400**, and a status display part **500**.

[0063] First, the processing part **100** is provided to process food and microorganisms by accommodating and stirring them.

[0064] More specifically, the processing part **100** is configured to include a chamber **110**, a rotating shaft **120**, a stirring rod **130**, a first blade **140**, and a second blade **150**, as illustrated in FIGS. 2 and 3.

[0065] Here, the chamber **110** forms a predetermined accommodation space so that food and microorganisms are accommodated inside, and is formed so that the lower part has a semi-cylindrical shape, as illustrated in FIGS. 3a and 3b.

[0066] Accordingly, the food waste disposer of the present disclosure includes a chamber **110** formed so that the lower part has a semi-cylindrical shape, thereby allowing the food and microorganisms inside to gather toward the center while being stirred by the stirring rod and the blade, thereby preventing the formation of an area in which the food and microorganisms are not stirred and accumulate in the lower side part, thereby providing an effect of preventing the decomposition and processing efficiency of the food from being reduced.

[0067] In addition, the rotating shaft **120** is characterized by being rotationally driven inside the chamber **110**.

[0068] Here, the rotating shaft **120** is disposed in a direction perpendicular to the direction in which food and microorganisms are introduced into the chamber **110**, and both ends are coupled and fixed to center parts of the side surfaces of the chamber **110**.

[0069] In addition, the stirring rod **130**, as illustrated in FIGS. 2 and 3, is provided so that one end is vertically coupled to the outer circumferential surface of the rotating shaft **120** and is driven together with the rotating shaft **120** to stir food and microorganisms accommodated in the chamber **110**.

[0070] Next, the first blade **140** is characterized by being coupled to the other end of the stirring rod **130** in a direction perpendicular to the longitudinal direction of the stirring rod **130** to form a predetermined contact area to come into contact with food and microorganisms.

[0071] More specifically, the first blade **140**, as illustrated in FIG. 3, is disposed at a predetermined angle tilted from the rotating shaft **120** to form an oblique line.

[0072] In addition, the second blade **150** is characterized by being coupled to a side surface of the stirring rod **130** in a direction parallel to the longitudinal direction of the stirring rod **130** to form a predetermined contact area to come into contact with food and microorganisms.

[0073] More specifically, the second blade **150**, as illustrated in FIG. 3, is disposed so that the width direction is perpendicular to the longitudinal direction of the rotating shaft **120**.

[0074] Here, the first blade **140** and the second blade **150** are characterized by being coupled to intersect with each other at a predetermined angle on the stirring rod **130**.

[0075] As described above, the food waste disposer of the present disclosure may perform the function of separating clumped portions by rotating to separate food and microorganisms inside the chamber in diagonal and vertical directions from top to bottom or bottom to top by the coupled structure of the first blade **140** and the second blade **150**, and the food and microorganisms that come into contact with each of the first blade **140** and the second blade **150** may be pushed in different directions and stirred, thereby pushing the food and microorganisms in multi-directions rather than one direction and mixing them, thereby improving the stirring efficiency and the food processing efficiency.

[0076] Next, the input part **200** is formed on the upper part of the processing part **100** and is provided so that food and microorganisms are introduced from the outside into the chamber **110**.

[0077] In addition, the driving part **300** is characterized by providing power so that the rotating shaft **120** and the stirring rod **130** are rotationally driven.

[0078] In addition, the discharge part **400** is provided to discharge the food decomposed through the processing part **100** to the outside.

[0079] Hereinafter, the input part **200** and the discharge part **400** will be described in more detail

with reference to FIGS. **9** to **13** to be described later.

[0080] Next, the status display part **500** is characterized by being provided to output various information, including information about an operation status of the food waste disposer **1000**, information about the food and microorganisms accommodated inside the chamber **110**, and information about a progress status of food processing, in visual and auditory forms.

[0081] Next, the processing part **100** of the food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure will be described with reference to FIGS. **4** to **8**.

[0082] In proceeding with the description of the additional embodiment of the present disclosure, expressions that are redundant with the above-described embodiment of the present disclosure will be omitted for the sake of concise description of the disclosure.

[0083] FIG. **4** is a plan view illustrating a processing part of a food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure, FIG. **5** is a diagram illustrating a detailed configuration of a processing part of a food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure, and FIG. **6** is a diagram illustrating a detailed configuration of a processing part of a food waste disposer according to another additional embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0084] In addition, FIG. **7** is a diagram illustrating a first blade and a second blade according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure, and FIG. **8** is a diagram illustrating a detailed configuration of a processing part of a food waste disposer according to another embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0085] First, as illustrated in FIG. **4**, the chamber **110** of the food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure includes a chamfered part **111**.

[0086] Here, the chamfered part **111** is provided to form a sloped surface of a predetermined angle on at least one edge of the chamber **110**.

[0087] At this time, the length of the stirring rod coupled to the vicinity of the area where the chamfered part **111** is formed, i.e., the both end parts of the rotating shaft **120**, is formed shorter than the length of the stirring rod coupled to the center part of the rotating shaft **120**, so that the driving resistance occurring in the stirring rod at both end parts of the rotating shaft **120** may be minimized.

[0088] Accordingly, the food waste disposer of the present disclosure includes the chamfered part **111** formed at the edge of the chamber, thereby preventing the formation of a blind spot or dead zone in which food and microorganisms are not stirred because they do not come into contact with the stirring rod or blade, thereby further improving the efficiency of decomposition and processing of the food waste disposer, and by forming the length of the stirring rod near the chamfered part short, the driving resistance occurring in the stirring rod may be minimized, thereby providing an effect of preventing damage to the food waste disposer.

[0089] Next, the rotating shaft **120** of the food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure is characterized by having a screw thread **121**, as illustrated in FIG. **5**.

[0090] Here, the screw thread **121** is provided on the outer circumferential surface of the rotating shaft **120** to form a movement path of the stirring rod **130**.

[0091] At this time, the stirring rod **130** is characterized by being rotationally driven while moving along the longitudinal direction of the rotating shaft **120**, i.e., along the screw thread **121** described above, on the outer circumferential surface of the rotating shaft **120**.

[0092] More specifically, a plurality of the stirring rods **130** are provided so that each stirring rod **130** is configured to be movable in a form of gathering toward a longitudinal center of the rotating shaft **120** or scattering toward both ends of the rotating shaft **120**.

[0093] As described above, in the food waste disposer of the present disclosure, the stirring rod may move in both directions on the outer circumferential surface of the rotating shaft through the screw thread **121**, and in order to improve the limitation that stirring is only performed within the

rotation radius of the location where the fixed stirring rod is located, the stirring area is expanded by moving the location of the stirring rod, thereby providing the effect of preventing the formation of a blind spot where food and microorganisms accumulate between the stirring rods.

[0094] In addition, the rotating shaft **120** of the food waste disposer according to another additional embodiment of the present disclosure is characterized by including a slot **122**, as illustrated in FIG. **6**.

[0095] Here, the slot **122** is formed by recessing or penetrating a predetermined depth from the outer circumferential surface of the rotating shaft **120** toward the center, i.e., the center of a circle based on the longitudinal vertical cross-section of the rotating shaft.

[0096] More specifically, a plurality of the slots **122** are provided and characterized by being spaced apart from each other by a predetermined distance in the longitudinal direction of the rotating shaft **120**.

[0097] Here, the above-described stirring rod **130** is configured to be detachably attached to the slot **122**, allowing an installation location to be changed according to a formation location of the slot **122**.

[0098] For example, the stirring rod **130** may be released from its existing location and moved to a location of the slot **122** close to the longitudinal center of the rotating shaft **120** and coupled using a separate fastening member such as a bolt.

[0099] Accordingly, by including the slot **122**, the food waste disposer of the present disclosure may improve the decomposition power of food by moving the installation location of the stirring rod according to the type, characteristics, and condition of the food and adjusting the gap between the plurality of stirring rods.

[0100] Next, the first blade **140** of the food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure includes a first brush **141**, as illustrated in FIG. **7**.

[0101] Here, the first brush **141** is formed to be detachably attached to one end part of the first blade **140**, on which areas recessed from the outer side toward the center to a predetermined depth are repeatedly formed while being spaced apart from each other by a predetermined distance.

[0102] In addition, the second blade **150** of the food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure includes a second brush **151**, as illustrated in FIG. **7**.

[0103] Here, the second brush **151** is characterized by being formed to be detachably attached to one side end part of the second blade **150**, on which areas recessed from the outer side toward the center to a predetermined depth are repeatedly formed while being spaced apart from each other by a predetermined distance.

[0104] More specifically, the first brush **141** and the second brush **151** may be made of a hard material such as plastic, or a soft material such as rubber and silicone, and may be applied to various types of food, respectively, or may be used for the purpose of cleaning the inside of the chamber.

[0105] As described above, the food waste disposer of the present disclosure includes first and second brushes **141**, **151** that are formed to be detachably attached to the first and second blades **140**, **150**, so that the shape of the blades may be changed when using depending on the type or characteristics of the food to be processed, and food may be prevented from becoming entangled or lumped, so that the stirring of food and microorganisms may be facilitated, thereby providing an effect of improving the speed of food processing.

[0106] In addition, the processing part **100** of the food waste disposer according to another embodiment of the present disclosure includes a third blade **160**, as illustrated in FIG. **8**. Here, the third blade **160** is characterized by having a plate shape and a bending part **161** having a predetermined angle.

[0107] In addition, the third blade **160** is formed by being coupled to the stirring rod **130** so that both side surfaces contact the side surface of the stirring rod **130** based on the bending part **161** to form a predetermined contact area to contact the food and microorganisms according to the

rotational drive of the rotating shaft **120**.

[0108] More specifically, as illustrated in FIG. **8**, a plurality of the third blade **160** are provided and characterized by being disposed to be spaced apart from each other by a predetermined distance in the longitudinal direction of the stirring rod **130**.

[0109] Accordingly, by including the third blade **160**, the food waste disposer of the present disclosure may evenly flow and stir food and microorganisms to both sides based on the bending part according to the rotation of the stirring rod fixedly coupled to the rotating shaft, and it is applied partially in multiple parts rather than as a single whole in the longitudinal direction of the stirring rod to prevent stress from being concentrated on the stirring rod when rotating, thereby preventing damage to the stirring rod and blade in advance.

[0110] Next, an input part of a food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure will be described with reference to FIGS. **1**, **2**, **9**, and **10**.

[0111] FIG. **9** is a diagram illustrating a detailed configuration of an input part of a food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, and FIG. **10** is a cross-sectional view illustrating a cover packing of a food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0112] First, the input part **200**, as described above, is formed on the upper part of the processing part **100** described above and provided so that the food and microorganisms are introduced from the outside into the chamber **110**.

[0113] In addition, the input part **200** includes an input port **210**, an input cover **220**, a cover packing **230**, and a distance sensor **240**, as illustrated in FIGS. **1** and **9**.

[0114] The input port **210** is formed so that a predetermined area of the input part **200** is open.

[0115] In addition, the input cover **220** is provided so as to open and close the input port **210**.

[0116] In addition, the cover packing **230** is characterized in that it is formed by being attached to the lower edge of the input cover **220** and provided to seal the chamber when the input port **210** is closed, as illustrated in FIGS. **9A** and **9B**.

[0117] Here, the cover packing **230** includes a protrusion **231** as illustrated in FIGS. **9B** and **10**.

[0118] More specifically, the protrusion **231** is formed to protrude in the vertical direction from one surface of the cover packing **230** toward the outside at a predetermined height, and is characterized in that at least one is formed along the longitudinal direction of the cover packing **230**.

[0119] Here, the cover packing **230** is made of a soft material such as rubber or silicone, and when the input cover **220** is closed to close the input port, it contacts the inner side surface or the periphery of the input port and adheres more strongly due to the shape deformation of the protrusion **231**, thereby preventing dust generated inside the chamber from leaking out through the input port to further improve the sealing capacity of the space inside the chamber.

[0120] Next, the distance sensor **240** mounted in the vertical direction on the lower surface of the input cover **220** and provided to detect the height of the food and microorganisms accommodated inside the chamber when the input port is closed.

[0121] More specifically, the distance sensor **240** is characterized by generating a warning notification when the detected height of the food and microorganisms exceeds a preset reference range.

[0122] Here, information about the height of the food and microorganisms detected by the distance sensor **240** and information such as the generated warning notification may be output through the status display part described above.

[0123] Accordingly, the food waste disposer of the present disclosure includes a distance sensor **240** that detects the height of food and microorganisms accommodated inside the chamber and generates a warning notification when the height exceeds a reference range, thereby preventing excessive food from being introduced into the chamber and reducing the efficiency of decomposition and processing of the food, and the process of a user directly opening the input cover and visually checking the input amount when using the food waste disposer is unnecessary,

thereby providing an effect of increasing user convenience.

[0124] Next, a discharge part of a food waste disposer according to an embodiment, an additional embodiment, and another embodiment of the present disclosure will be described with reference to FIGS. **1** and **11**.

[0125] FIG. **11** is a front view illustrating a discharge part of a food waste disposer according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0126] First, the discharge part **400** is provided to discharge the food decomposed through the above-described processing part **100** to the outside as described above.

[0127] In addition, the discharge part **400** includes a discharge port **410**, a discharge cover **420**, and a stand **430** as illustrated in FIGS. **1** and **11**.

[0128] Here, the discharge port **410** is provided on one side of the processing part **100** and is formed to so that a predetermined area is open.

[0129] In addition, the discharge cover **420** is provided to open and close the discharge port **410**.

[0130] More specifically, the discharge cover **420** may be formed with a handle that may be gripped by a user or an operator as illustrated in FIGS. **1** and **11**.

[0131] In addition, the discharge cover **420** is provided so that a part of the upper end is hung on the upper part of the discharge port **410**, and when opened, the discharge cover **420** is rotated outward from the discharge port **410** using the handle formed at the lower part so that the discharge cover is perpendicular to the discharge port, and the discharge cover is slid and inserted into the discharge port, thereby completely opening the discharge port.

[0132] In addition, the stand **430** is provided so as to form a discharge path while supporting the decomposed food discharged from the discharge port **410**.

[0133] Next, a discharge part of a food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure will be described with reference to FIGS. **12** and **13**.

[0134] FIG. **12** is a perspective view illustrating a discharge part of a food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure, and FIG. **13** is a diagram illustrating a sequence for opening a discharge part of a food waste disposer according to an additional embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0135] First, the discharge part **400** of the food waste disposer of the present disclosure further includes a mesh box **440**, as illustrated in FIGS. **12** and **13**.

[0136] The mesh box **440** is formed by being coupled to both sides of the discharge port so as to cover the discharge port **410** while forming a predetermined hollow area near the discharge port **410**.

[0137] More specifically, the mesh box **440** is provided to be movable up and down based on the discharge port **410**, as illustrated in FIGS. **13B** and **13C**.

[0138] Here, the mesh box **440** is provided in a mesh shape in which a plurality of holes are formed.

[0139] Accordingly, the food waste disposer of the present disclosure includes a mesh box **440** that forms a hollow area near the discharge port and is movable up and down based on the discharge port, thereby ensuring a safe distance for the user or operator from the discharge port, thereby providing an effect of preventing an accident from occurring in advance due to the user's or operator's hand being caught inside the discharge port while the food waste disposer is in operation.

[0140] The opening of the discharge part **400** using the mesh box **440** is performed in the order of FIGS. **13A** to **13D**.

[0141] FIG. **13A** is a diagram illustrating a state in which the discharge port is closed by the mesh box **440** and the discharge cover, and FIG. **13B** is a diagram illustrating a state in which the discharge port is closed only by the discharge cover **420** by moving the mesh box **440** up based on the discharge port **410**.

[0142] Here, the mesh box **440** may be coupled so that only the left and right side parts are hung around the discharge port **410**, and moved by sliding when moving up and down.

[0143] Next, FIG. 13C illustrates a state in which the discharge port **410** is completely opened by opening the discharge cover **420** while the mesh box **440** is moved up, and FIG. 13D illustrates a state in which the mesh box **440** is moved down again to form a predetermined hollow area near the discharge port **410** and cover the discharge port **410**.

[0144] Afterwards, when the decomposed food is discharged from the inside of the chamber of the above-described processing part to the discharge port, the front surface of the discharge port **410** is covered by the mesh box **440**, and the food flows out to the lower part of the discharge port, i.e., the stand **430**, so that safe discharge of the food is possible.

[0145] Next, a discharge part of a food waste disposer according to another embodiment of the present disclosure will be described with reference to FIGS. **14** and **15**.

[0146] FIG. **14** is a perspective view illustrating a discharge part of a food waste disposer according to another embodiment of the present disclosure, and FIG. **15** is a side view illustrating a closed state and an open state of a discharge cover of a discharge part of a food waste disposer according to another embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0147] First, the discharge cover **420** of the food waste disposer of the present disclosure may be provided in a mesh shape in which a plurality of holes are formed, as illustrated in FIGS. **14** and **15**.

[0148] More specifically, the discharge cover **420** is characterized by, as illustrated in FIG. **15**, being formed so that the upper end is fixedly coupled to the upper part of the discharge port and the lower part is rotatable in the outward direction from the discharge port based on the upper end.

[0149] Here, FIG. **15A** is a diagram illustrating the discharge part **400** in a state where the discharge port is closed by the discharge cover **420**, and FIG. **15B** is a diagram illustrating the discharge part **400** in a state where the discharge port is opened by the discharge cover **420**.

[0150] More specifically, the opening of the discharge port is performed in a form in which, as illustrated in FIG. **15B**, the discharge cover **420** is fixed to the upper end, the decomposed food is pushed out from inside the chamber to the discharge port, and the lower part of the discharge cover **420** rotates due to the weight of the food, thereby opening the discharge port.

[0151] Accordingly, the food waste disposer of the present disclosure includes a discharge cover **420** provided in a mesh form, thereby ensuring a safe distance for the user or operator from the discharge port, and providing an effect of preventing a safety accident from occurring when the user or operator's hand gets caught inside the discharge port during the operation and driving of the food waste disposer.

[0152] Although the present disclosure has been described above with specific details such as specific components, limited embodiments, and drawings, these have been provided only to help a more general understanding of the present disclosure, and the present disclosure is not limited to the above embodiments, and those skilled in the art may attempt various modifications and variations from this description.

[0153] Therefore, the idea of the present disclosure should not be limited to the embodiments described above, and not only the appended claims but also all modifications equivalent to or equivalent to the claims are included in the scope of the idea of the present disclosure.

TABLE-US-00001 <Explanation of Symbols> 1000: Food waste disposer 100: Processing part 110: Chamber 111: Chamfered part 120: Rotating shaft 121: Screw thread 122: Slot 130: Stirring rod 140: First blade 141: First brush 150: Second blade 151: Second brush 160: Third blade 161: Bending part 200: Input part 210: Input port 220: Input cover 230: Cover packing 231: Protrusion 240: Distance sensor 300: Driving part 400: Discharge part 410: Discharge port 420: Discharge cover 430: Stand 440: Mesh box 500: Status display part

Claims

1. A food waste disposer for stirring food and microorganisms to process the food to be decomposed, the food waste disposer comprising: a processing part **100** provided with a chamber **110** formed so that a predetermined accommodation space is formed to accommodate food and microorganisms inside and a lower part has a semi-cylindrical shape, a rotating shaft **120** which is rotationally driven inside the chamber, and a stirring rod **130** having one end which is vertically connected to an outer circumferential surface of the rotating shaft and is driven together with the rotating shaft to stir the food and microorganisms accommodated in the chamber; an input part **200** formed on an upper part of the processing part and provided so that the food and microorganisms are introduced from outside into the chamber, in which an input port **210** is formed so that a predetermined area is open; a driving part **300** configured to provide power so that the rotating shaft and the stirring rod are rotationally driven; and a discharge part **400** provided to discharge the food decomposed through the processing part to the outside, wherein the chamber **110** is provided with a chamfered part **111** configured to form a sloped surface of a predetermined angle on at least one edge, the stirring rod **130** is rotationally driven while moving along a longitudinal direction of the rotating shaft on the outer circumferential surface of the rotating shaft, and a plurality of the stirring rods are provided so that each stirring rod is movable in a form of gathering toward a center in the longitudinal direction of the rotating shaft or scattering toward both ends of the rotating shaft, and the rotating shaft **120** is provided with a screw thread **121** on the outer circumferential surface to form a movement path of the stirring rod.
2. The food waste disposer according to claim 1, wherein the rotating shaft **120** is disposed in a direction perpendicular to a direction in which the food and microorganisms are introduced into the chamber and has both ends coupled and fixed to center parts of side surfaces of the chamber.
3. The food waste disposer according to claim 1, wherein the rotating shaft **120** further comprises a plurality of slots **122** formed to be recessed or penetrate to a predetermined depth from the outer circumferential surface toward a center and spaced apart from each other by a predetermined distance in the longitudinal direction of the rotating shaft, and the stirring rod **130** is provided to be detachably attached to the slot, allowing an installation location to be changed according to a formation location of the slot.
4. The food waste disposer according to claim 1, wherein the processing part **100** comprises a first blade **140** which is coupled to another end of the stirring rod being perpendicular to a longitudinal direction of the stirring rod to form a predetermined contact area to contact the food and microorganisms.
5. The food waste disposer according to claim 4, wherein the first blade **140** is disposed at a predetermined angle tilted from the rotating shaft to form an oblique line.
6. The food waste disposer according to claim 4, wherein the first blade **140** further comprises a first brush **141** formed to be detachably attached to one end part of the first blade, on which areas recessed from an outer side toward a center to a predetermined depth are repeatedly formed while being spaced apart from each other by a predetermined distance.
7. The food waste disposer according to claim 1, wherein the processing part **100** comprises a second blade **150** which is coupled to a side surface of the stirring rod being parallel to a longitudinal direction of the stirring rod to form a predetermined contact area to contact the food and microorganisms.
8. The food waste disposer according to claim 7, wherein the second blade **150** is disposed so that a width direction is perpendicular to the longitudinal direction of the rotating shaft.
9. The food waste disposer according to claim 7, wherein the second blade **150** further comprises a second brush **151** formed to be detachably attached to one side end part of the second blade, on which areas recessed from an outer side toward a center to a predetermined depth are repeatedly formed while being spaced apart from each other by a predetermined distance.
10. The food waste disposer according to claim 1, wherein the processing part **100** comprises a

third blade **160** having a plate shape and provided with a bending part **161** of a predetermined angle, and formed by being coupled to the stirring rod so that both surfaces contact a side surface of the stirring rod based on the bending part to form a predetermined contact area to contact the food and microorganisms.

11. The food waste disposer according to claim 10, wherein a plurality of the third blades **160** are provided and disposed to be spaced apart from each other by a predetermined distance in a longitudinal direction of the stirring rod.

12. The food waste disposer according to claim 1, wherein the input part **200** comprises: an input cover **220** provided to open and close the input port; and a cover packing **230** formed by being attached to a lower edge of the input cover and provided to seal the chamber when the input port is closed.

13. The food waste disposer according to claim 12, wherein the cover packing **230** comprises at least one protrusion **231** formed to protrude in a vertical direction from one surface toward the outside at a predetermined height and formed along a longitudinal direction of the cover packing.

14. The food waste disposer according to claim 12, wherein the input part **200** comprises a distance sensor **240** mounted in a vertical direction on a lower surface of the input cover and provided to detect a height of the food and microorganisms accommodated inside the chamber when the input port is closed.

15. The food waste disposer according to claim 14, wherein the distance sensor **240** is configured to generate a warning notification when the detected height of the food and microorganisms exceeds a preset reference range.

16. The food waste disposer according to claim 1, wherein the discharge part **400** comprises: a discharge port **410** provided on one side of the processing part and formed so that a predetermined area is open; and a discharge cover **420** provided to open and close the discharge port.

17. The food waste disposer according to claim 16, wherein the discharge part **400** further comprises a mesh box **440** formed by being coupled to both sides of the discharge port so as to cover the discharge port while forming a predetermined hollow area near the discharge port and provided to be movable up and down based on the discharge port.

18. The food waste disposer according to claim 16, wherein the discharge cover **420** is formed so that an upper end is fixedly coupled to an upper part of the discharge port and a lower part is rotatable in an outward direction from the discharge port based on the upper end, and is provided in a mesh form in which a plurality of holes are formed.

19. The food waste disposer according to claim 1, further comprising a status display part **500** provided to output various information, including information about an operation status of the food waste disposer, information about the food and microorganisms accommodated inside the chamber, and information about a progress status of food processing, in visual and auditory forms.
